

Business Case Note

Official Website and Customer Enquiry Management System for a UK Auto Parts SME

Client Name	Auto Parts SME
Prepared By	Business Analyst
Working Date	16 May 20xx
Sprint / Stage	Sprint 0 Closure / Stage 14
Document Version	v1.0

1. Purpose

This Business Case Note explains why Auto Parts SME should invest in a simple official website and customer enquiry management capability. It is a light business case suitable for a small business website project and supports Sprint 1 planning.

2. Business Problem

- Customer enquiries are currently received through phone calls, WhatsApp messages, emails, and informal messages.
- Customer details are not captured in a consistent format.
- The business has no single official place where customers can understand services and product categories.
- Manual follow-up increases the risk of missed enquiries or delayed response.
- Customer-facing information such as policies, contact details, and business information is not structured in one digital location.

3. Proposed Solution

Deliver a responsive official website for Auto Parts SME with company information, product/category sections, Request a Quote form, Contact Us page, Feedback form, newsletter subscription, footer links, and required information pages. Phase 1 will focus on website visibility and enquiry capture through email notification. SQL and Power BI reporting will remain a future Phase 2 enhancement.

4. Expected Business Benefits

Benefit Area	Expected Benefit	Example
Customer access	Customers can view company information and categories online.	A customer can check engine, lighting, gearbox, and body part categories before contacting the business.
Enquiry quality	Quote requests can capture required details in a standard format.	Name, email, phone, vehicle details, product category, and message can be collected together.
Response process	Email notification helps the business identify new enquiries quickly.	Sales team receives a form submission alert and follows up manually.
Professional presence	A structured website improves trust and visibility.	Customers can see About Us, Contact Us, policy pages, and service information.
Future reporting	Enquiry data can support future lead tracking.	Phase 2 may introduce SQL and Power BI reporting after the website is live.

5. Phase 1 Scope Summary

- Home page, About Us, product/category sections, Request a Quote form, Contact Us, Feedback form, and newsletter subscription.
- Footer with customer service links and legal/information pages.
- Privacy Policy, Cookie Policy, Terms and Conditions, and Delivery / Returns information pages.
- Responsive layout for desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- Basic Search Engine Optimisation requirements and basic analytics if agreed.
- Email notification to the business when quote/contact forms are submitted.
- Testing, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), release readiness, and go-live support.

6. Phase 1 Out of Scope

- Customer login, online payment gateway, full e-commerce checkout, live inventory, customer dashboard, complex admin portal, mobile app, API integration, SQL dashboard, and Power BI dashboard.
- Advanced product recommendation engine and automated sales lead workflow.

7. High-Level Options Considered

Option	Description	Pros	Cons
Option 1	Continue manual enquiry process only.	No build cost.	No professional website presence, inconsistent enquiry capture, and no structured customer journey.
Option 2	Build simple official website with enquiry forms.	Supports online presence, structured enquiry capture, and realistic MVP delivery.	Requires content, design, testing, and compliance review.
Option 3	Build full e-commerce platform.	Can support online selling in future.	Too large for Phase 1, higher cost, more compliance and payment complexity.

8. Recommended Option

Recommended option: Option 2 - build a simple official website with enquiry and quote request capability. This option is suitable for Phase 1 because it addresses the current business problem without adding unnecessary e-commerce, payment, live inventory, login, or dashboard complexity.

9. Key Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Delay in approved content	May delay page build and review.	Assign content owner and confirm content deadlines.
Unconfirmed claims	May create customer trust or compliance issue.	Business Owner to confirm or remove claims such as free shipping, secure payment, money back, discount, and support availability.
Unclear form fields	May reduce enquiry quality.	Confirm required fields with Sales / Enquiry Handling Team.
Missing compliance review	May delay release readiness.	Track privacy, cookie, newsletter, company information, and legal page requirements early.

10. Regulation / Compliance Consideration

This section is written from a Business Analyst perspective and is not legal advice. The Business Analyst identifies and tracks compliance-related requirements. Final wording and legal accuracy should be confirmed by the Business Owner or relevant advisor.

- Privacy notice for enquiry, contact, feedback, and newsletter forms.
- Cookie notice and cookie preference requirement if analytics or non-essential cookies are used.
- Newsletter consent and unsubscribe option.
- Company information and legal pages.
- Delivery / Returns wording if required by the business.
- Validation of customer-facing claims before publication.

- Basic accessibility requirements such as form labels, readable contrast, error messages, alt text, keyboard navigation, and mobile-friendly layout.

11. SQL / Power BI Involvement

No SQL or Power BI delivery is included in Phase 1. Phase 2 may introduce a Customer Enquiry and Sales Lead Tracking Dashboard using SQL and Power BI after the website is live and enquiry data requirements are confirmed.

12. Decision Required

The Business Owner and Product Owner should confirm whether the project should proceed into Sprint 1 for Business Requirements Document, Non-Functional Requirements, homepage/navigation/footer requirements, and Figma wireframe review.